CSE0001 - Digital Literacy Project Report

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Branch: Computer Science and Engineering

Year: 2025-2029

Course Code: CSE0001

Date: March 31, 2026

Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador at VIT Bhopal University, my role is to help peers navigate the digital world safely and professionally. This project serves as a Digital Literacy Portfolio, documenting my proficiency across five key modules: visual communication, professional branding, technical collaboration, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness. Through these tasks, I have built a structured GitHub repository that demonstrates my ability to use modern digital tools while maintaining high standards of online responsibility.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

I created a comprehensive "Students Guide to Digital Literacy" infographic using a digital design tool. The visual resource covers five critical areas: the definition of digital literacy, essential student tools like GitHub and Google Workspace, safe internet practices such as 2FA, professional online presence on LinkedIn, and professional email etiquette.

The design uses a clean, five-column layout with distinct icons for each section to ensure the information is easily digestible for my peers. What I found most interesting while making this was the realization that digital literacy is a holistic approach to safety and professional communication. The most challenging part was ensuring the text was concise enough to fit into a single-page visual while still being informative.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I established a foundational digital presence by setting up and optimizing profiles on LinkedIn, GitHub, Stack Overflow, and Kaggle. Each platform serves a distinct professional purpose. LinkedIn is my primary networking tool, where I detailed my B. Tech studies at VIT Bhopal. GitHub serves as my technical portfolio; I created a specialized Profile README to showcase my interest in full-stack web development and Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA).

Stack Overflow was chosen for technical collaboration, while Kaggle provides a specialized environment for practicing Python and data visualization. Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a living record of my technical growth. I will host my coding projects on GitHub to build a credible resume while using LinkedIn to track internship milestones.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

I explored both technical and collaborative digital platforms by completing a coding challenge on Hacker Rank and building a five-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms. This exercise involved creating a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions designed to educate my peers on account safety and professional communication.

I also linked the form to a Google Sheet to practice real-time data collection. These tools are highly relevant to my academic career; coding platforms prepare me for technical interviews, while Google Workspace tools are essential for collaborating on group projects and organizing research data.

Task 4: Draft a Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

I practiced professional communication by drafting formal emails and a social media etiquette guide. A significant real-world problem caused by poor digital communication often occurs when students use informal language in emails to professors. In a hypothetical scenario, a student might send a message with no subject line and a casual greeting like "Hey," which can lead to the request being ignored.

To prevent this, I learned that a professional email must always include a clear subject line with my name and registration number, a formal salutation, and a concise body. My social media checklist also highlights the importance of maintaining a professional boundary between personal and academic life.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention

While researching Task 5, I was most surprised to learn how sophisticated QR code scams have become, specifically targeting students on online marketplaces. I previously assumed that scanning a code was always a safe way to verify an identity, but I now realize it can be used to authorize unauthorized withdrawals.

As a result, one habit I will personally change is never entering my UPI PIN unless I am the one intentionally making a payment. This task highlighted that being a Digital Ambassador requires constant vigilance and the ability to educate others on the latest reporting channels, such as the 1930 helpline and the National Cyber Crime Portal.

Conclusion

This project has significantly improved my digital resilience and professional identity. By integrating technical skills like GitHub management and coding with "soft" digital skills like email etiquette and cybersecurity awareness, I am now better equipped to serve as a Student Digital Ambassador. These foundational skills will be vital as I progress through my Computer Science degree and enter the professional tech industry.

References

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- **Google Workspace:** forms.google.com
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- **Kaggle:** kaggle.com
- **National Cyber Crime Portal:** cybercrime.gov.in